

Introducing the gut–brain approach

A one-page primer on psychologically-informed care for disorders of gut–brain interaction.

Brain–gut behavioural therapies are now recommended as part of best-practice care for disorders of gut–brain interaction. EF Health provides this psychological arm as a structured, collaborative adjunct to medical management – never as an alternative to it.

Who benefits from referral

- Patients with IBS, functional dyspepsia, chronic nausea, functional constipation or motility disorders
- Especially where **symptom hypervigilance**, **health anxiety** or **food-related anxiety** are prominent
- Patients whose symptoms are affecting function, mood or quality of life despite medical management

The EF Health pathway

- 1 Referral** — GP, specialist, allied health, or self-referral
- 2 Intake & clinical review** — history and goals assessed by a psychologist
- 3 Triage** — matched to individual therapy, the 5-week group programme, or self-paced learning
- 4 Treatment & review** — evidence-based care with outcomes measured and next steps agreed

How we work with you

- **Collaborative.** Psychological care runs alongside your management, coordinated to one plan.
- **Communicative.** With patient consent, you receive brief, practical updates — formulation, pathway and progress.
- **Framework.** Care follows the Executive Frame™ — Centre, Clarify, Choose — integrating emotional intelligence, executive functioning, self-determination theory and gut–brain science.

To refer

Use the secure referral form at executiveframe.co.nz, or contact the practice directly. Patient-facing information sheets are free to download and share at the point of referral.

This sheet is general information — not a diagnosis or a substitute for medical care. EF Health psychological support works alongside your medical team, never instead of it. If your symptoms are new, severe, or changing, please speak with your GP or specialist.

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